Name: _____ Date: _____

THE CONSTITUTION

Signing did not start the government
1787 · 1788 · 1789

Just Listen Learning • Episode 12 • Just listen, together.

1. Who or What Am I?

Write the word from the box that matches each clue.

Articles	Shays	Convention	Compromise
Electors	Delaware	Publius	Ratify

1. First plan after the war; Congress could not tax directly _____
2. Massachusetts uprising, 1786–1787, over debt and taxes _____
3. Philadelphia meeting, May 25 to September 17, 1787 _____
4. July 16 plan: House by population, two senators each _____
5. Chosen to pick the president; number equals reps + senators _____
6. First state to approve, December 7, 1787 _____
7. Shared pen name of Hamilton, Madison, and Jay _____
8. To approve the plan in a special state convention _____

2. Poster Time!

Draw the Rising Sun Chair

Draw Washington's chair with a sun on the back, in the Assembly Room (no fighting). Then finish the sentence.

Franklin said the sun was: _____

3. Then and Now: True or False?

Read each sentence. Write T if it is true or F if it is false.

____ 1. Congress could not directly tax people under the Articles of Confederation.

____ 2. The working Convention began on May 14, 1787, as soon as it was called.

____ 3. Thomas Jefferson wrote the Constitution in Philadelphia.

____ 4. The Constitution was signed on September 17, 1787.

____ 5. Signing the Constitution immediately started the new government.

____ 6. New Hampshire became the ninth state to ratify on June 21, 1788.

____ 7. The Constitution set up three branches: Congress makes the laws, a president carries them out, and the courts judge cases.

4. Think About It!

Answer in complete sentences.

1. Why did signing the Constitution on September 17, 1787, not start the new government?

_____

_____

2. Name two different compromises or arrangements made at the Convention.

_____

_____

5. Timeline

Number the events 1 to 5, earliest first.

- ____ New government set to begin
- ____ Constitution signed in Philadelphia
- ____ New Hampshire is the ninth
- ____ Shays' Rebellion
- ____ Delaware ratifies first

☆ **A first plan, a summer convention, a signature, then ratification, then a start date.** ☆

Answer Key: The Constitution

Just Listen Learning • Episode 12 • For parents and teachers

1. Who or What Am I?

1. Articles
2. Shays
3. Convention
4. Compromise
5. Electors
6. Delaware
7. Publius
8. Ratify

2. Poster Time!

Drawings will vary. Look for a chair, a sun design, and a meeting room — keep it non-graphic.

3. Then and Now: True or False?

1. T (National Archives / Mount Vernon / National Constitution Center)
2. F (Called for May 14; a quorum was not present until May 25 — NARA and BYU Studies)
3. F (Jefferson was serving in France; NARA and National Constitution Center)
4. T (NCC Convention Facts; National Archives Q&A; NPS)
5. F (It still needed ratification; government was set to begin March 4, 1789)
6. T (National Archives Q&A; National Constitution Center)
7. T (NCC FAQs; Bill of Rights Institute; also National Archives, What Does it Say?)

4. Think About It!

1. The plan still had to be ratified by special state conventions; nine states were required, and the government was set to begin on March 4, 1789.
2. Any true pair: Great/Connecticut Compromise (House by population, two senators each); Electoral College / presidential electors; the three-fifths arrangement (separate from the Great Compromise).

5. Timeline

1. Shays' Rebellion (1786)
2. Constitution signed in Philadelphia (1787)
3. Delaware ratifies first (1787)
4. New Hampshire is the ninth (1788)
5. New government set to begin (1789)

Box numbers as printed, top to bottom: 5, 2, 4, 1, 3

All drawings on this worksheet are original line art. Facts come from the Just Listen episode "The Constitution".